

■ Police reforms

POLITICAL SLOTH

The states still have a lot of catching up to do

Even 26/11 had little impact on the three-year-old Supreme Court directive to accelerate reforms. Ten states have agreed to implement it on paper. Seven states are partially compliant. Twelve others have passed laws with a view to circumventing the implementation of the apex court fiat while Bihar has adopted a particularly regressive law. Meanwhile, the Central Government is raising more battalions of paramilitary forces. Till January 1 this year, the IPS was 557 officers short of its sanctioned strength of 3,889, of whom 314 fell in the direct recruitment quota. A recruitment plan, drawn up post-26/11, recommends 130 recruitments be made annually in the next 11 years in addition to holding of a limited competitive examination for deputy superintendents of police.

But states show complacency. Besides the four southern states, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Haryana have attempted at spending their allotted modernisation budgets. But states like Bihar, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh have barely spent their modernisation funds. There is a lot to be done—create a separate ministry of interiors whose sole purpose would be to ensure the internal security of India; shift to top gear the Prime Minister's Police Mission; increase the number of security experts in the MHA; choose police chiefs apolitically and establish Quick Reaction Teams (QRTs) in major cities of India.

by Amarnath K. Menon

WHAT'S DONE

■ Half the states are implementing police reforms while others circumvent a Supreme Court directive to do so

■ Centre is raising more battalions and recruiting more IPS officers

■ Modernisation funds are spent efficiently only by some states

WHAT'S NOT

■ Training for all personnel not improved

■ Massive manpower augmentation remains the big hole

557 IS THE SHORT-FALL OF OFFICERS IN THE INDIAN POLICE SERVICE WHICH HAS A SANCTIONED STRENGTH OF 3,889 OFFICERS.



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THE NEW FACE OF SECURITY

■ Megacity policing

RAPID REACTION

The Mumbai Police gets a makeover

As the first anniversary of the worst terror attack on Mumbai closes in, the authorities are working tirelessly to modernise the city police and beef up coastal security. If Mumbai Police's QRT was a measly group of 35 commandos on 26/11, it is now 1,500-strong with the police chief deploying them across the five regions of Mumbai city. Where the sanctioned budget for upgrading the police force was a meagre Rs 36 crore last year, this year it is Rs 102 crore. In terms of weaponry too, 39 combat vehicles with three sub-inspectors and 12 men in each have been deployed in 39 divisions.

The force has also added 160 new beat marshals, bulletproof speedboats and amphibious vehicles and even armed troop carriers besides the latest weapons. "Motivating my force is as important as adding modern weapons and technologies. I have made efforts to create a web of people that is more aware and have built on our intelligence-gathering skills," says Police Commissioner D. Sivanandhan.

Safeguarding the city's and also the state's coastline is also one of the main concerns of the Maharashtra government, but it has not as yet moved on the 12 sanctioned coastal police stations. However, Maharashtra additional chief secretary, Home, Chandra Iyengar says, "Eight of

1,500 is the strength of the Mumbai Police's Quick